

Engineering India's Foundation The Fastener Revolution That Built Self-Reliance

When infrastructure dreams were held hostage by imported screws, two brothers from Ghaziabad chose to manufacture India's independence—one fastener at a time.

In 1999, India's construction boom confronted an overlooked vulnerability. Every metro station, power plant, and railway shed utilizing modern color-coated sheet technology depended entirely on self-drilling screws imported from Taiwan. Project timelines stretched indefinitely, costs escalated unpredictably, and builders waited weeks for components as fundamental as screws to traverse the Indian Ocean.

The Lidoo brothers, Pankaj and Vipin identified what the industry ignored: India's infrastructure ambitions were held hostage to foreign suppliers for something as basic as a fastener. Rather than profiting from comfortable import trading, they pursued the arduous path of indigenous manufacturing, undertaking multiple research expeditions to Taiwan, committing substantial R&D investments, and navigating complex technology transfer negotiations to establish India's first specialized fastener manufacturing facility.

"We realized that India's infrastructure dreams were literally being held together by imported fasteners," recalls Pankaj Lidoo, Managing Director of Landmark Crafts. "Every construction delay, every cost overrun happened because builders had to wait for specialized screws from abroad."



PANKAJ LIDOO
Director
Landmark Crafts Ltd

VIPIN LIDOO
Managing Director
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By the early 2000s, as infrastructure spending accelerated nationwide, Landmark's products became the invisible sinews of national development. Delhi Metro's pioneering phases, BHEL installations, and Indian Railways projects relied on fasteners stamped "Made in India" for the first time. The company achieved manufacturing self-reliance in a critical industrial component while building a profitable enterprise—embodying "Make in India" decades before it became national policy.

The brothers understood India's diversity demanded customization beyond standardization. In Himachal Pradesh's timber-heavy construction zones, they supplied wood-specific solutions. Along Karnataka's coastline, anti-corrosive variants battled relentless salt air. For metro systems spanning multiple cities, they provided tailored fastening solutions addressing unique geological and structural requirements. This geographic and application-based customization became their definitive competitive advantage.

"In every assembled product, there is a fastener holding the structure strong

and safe," Pankaj explains. "We provide the strength you may not see, but you can always trust."

Today, Landmark operates ISO 9001:2015 certified facilities in Panchkula, backed by CRISIL SME-1 rating validating operational excellence. Their portfolio has expanded beyond self-drilling screws to encompass aluminium blind rivets and drywall screws, with concrete wall screws under development. A strategic distribution network ensures nationwide accessibility across India's vast geography.

Landmark's trajectory epitomizes transformation beyond headlines—from import dependence to indigenous capability, from technology buyer to infrastructure enabler. In an era obsessed with unicorn valuations and digital disruption, they represent different success metrics: measured in structural integrity rather than market buzz, in industrial self-reliance rather than venture funding rounds.

Sometimes the smallest components enable the biggest transformations. The most profound revolutions happen one screw at a time—quietly, persistently, holding the nation together.